ONE-DAY APPLIED LEARNING PROGRAM

THE ART OF STORYTELLING IN EDUCATION

A narrative-thinking lab for ideas, research, presentations and student leadership

04 PROGRAM

VALUE PROMISE: Meaning • Evidence • Memory • Influence

AUDIENCE	DURATION	FORMAT	CUSTOM PROGRAM
Students, researchers & faculty	1 day | 9:30-17:00	Story lab	Discuss with us

Why this matters now

FOR ACADEMIC LEADERS

Build a campus capability that helps students and researchers make complex ideas understandable, memorable and relevant to real audiences.

WHY STUDENTS NEED IT

Students may already learn presentation skills, but storytelling goes further: it teaches how to structure meaning, create relevance, translate evidence and make an idea memorable.

WHY ACADEMICIANS NEED IT

Academicians can use narrative thinking to strengthen teaching, research communication, supervision, grant pitches and industry conversations without sacrificing rigor.

Beyond soft skills

- Soft skills often cover speaking fluency, etiquette, confidence and presentation presence.
- Storytelling trains narrative structure, audience insight, evidence translation and memory.
- It is a thinking discipline before it becomes a speaking technique.

What participants gain

- **Make meaning:** organise complexity into a clear narrative.
- **Explain research:** connect problem, contribution, evidence and limitation.
- **Pitch innovation:** make the human problem and proposed future visible.
- **Lead with clarity:** adapt the same idea for professors, reviewers, employers or public audiences.

INSTITUTIONAL RETURN

Students who can make rigorous ideas legible to reviewers, employers, juries, partners and wider audiences.

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THE ART OF STORYTELLING IN EDUCATION

Storytelling is not the same as soft-skills training

The focus is narrative thinking: selecting meaning, structuring evidence and helping a specific audience understand why an idea matters.

One-day learning journey

09:30-10:15	**Why stories work**	Explore attention, memory, meaning and the difference between information and narrative.
10:15-11:15	**Audience and purpose**	Identify what a professor, reviewer, employer, investor or public audience needs to understand.
11:30-12:45	**Narrative architecture**	Build beginning, tension, insight, evidence and resolution around an idea.
13:45-15:00	**Research storytelling**	Turn a paper or project into a clear story of problem, contribution and evidence.
15:15-16:15	**Visual narrative**	Use slides, figures and examples as a guided reasoning journey rather than decoration.
16:15-17:00	**Three-minute story lab**	Deliver, receive critique and revise for clarity, credibility and impact.

Who should attend

- Undergraduate and postgraduate students
- Research scholars and project teams
- Innovation and entrepreneurship cohorts
- Faculty presenters and student leaders

Methods & tools

- Audience-purpose map
- Story spine and narrative arc
- Evidence-to-story canvas
- Research contribution narrative
- Visual storytelling principles
- Voice, pacing, questions and pauses

Takeaway toolkit

- A story map for a live academic or project topic
- A three-minute idea story
- A research or project narrative
- A one-slide story and final pitch
- A feedback-and-revision plan

Custom program

Custom programs can be discussed

The scope can be shaped around the cohort, institutional priorities and desired outcomes. Story canvas, narrative templates, feedback rubric and participation certificate can be included.

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THE INNOVATION FRAMEWORK

Three pillars of innovation

An idea becomes strategically interesting when it is **unique**, **hard to do** and **value adding** at the same time. The programs build student capability across all three.

01 UNIQUENESS

Meaningfully different

Students learn to ask whether the problem, insight or solution is genuinely different from what already exists - not merely a new implementation of a familiar idea.

SKILLS BUILT

Problem discovery, reframing, prior-art awareness, assumption breaking, divergent thinking and TRIZ.

02 HARD TO DO

Technically defensible

Innovation needs technical or execution depth. Students learn to work with constraints, contradictions, evidence and experiments so the idea is more than a superficial concept.

SKILLS BUILT

Systems thinking, technical trade-offs, experimentation, prototyping, non-obviousness and execution discipline.

03 VALUE ADDING

Creates real value

A clever idea is not automatically valuable. Students learn to connect innovation to a real user, institution, industry or societal need and define the change it should create.

SKILLS BUILT

Stakeholder insight, outcome framing, evidence, adoption thinking, value articulation and storytelling.

Why all three have to come together

Unique + valuable, but easy to copy	Interesting, but difficult to defend or sustain.
Unique + hard, but low value	Technically impressive, but unlikely to matter outside the project.
Hard + valuable, but not unique	Useful engineering, but limited differentiation or innovation claim.
Unique + hard + value adding	**A stronger foundation for defensible innovation and meaningful impact.**

How I help students build the three muscles

DISCOVER
Find tensions, unmet needs and consequential problems.

CHALLENGE
Question assumptions and seek a genuinely different angle.

BUILD
Work through constraints, contradictions and technical depth.

VALIDATE
Test evidence, stakeholder value, utility and feasibility.

COMMUNICATE
Turn the work into a research, patent or industry story.

THE CORE HABIT

Do not ask only, “Can we build it?” Ask: “Is it different? Is it difficult enough to be defensible? Does it create enough value to matter?”

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FROM INNOVATION CAPABILITY TO OUTCOMES

What the three pillars are designed to enable

The objective is not idea generation for its own sake. Students learn to convert differentiated, substantive and useful ideas into stronger research, invention and industry-facing evidence.

Outcome 01 - Impactful research

UNIQUENESS
A consequential question, clearer research gap and a contribution that is meaningfully different.

HARD TO DO
Technical depth, rigorous methods, experiments, difficult trade-offs and credible evidence.

VALUE ADDING
A problem that matters to a field, stakeholder, industry, society or future system.

STUDENT-OWNED EVIDENCE
Problem landscape • novelty map • research question • experiment plan • contribution statement • publication pathway.

Outcome 02 - Patents and defensible IP

UNIQUENESS
Prior-art awareness and a clearly differentiated mechanism, method or system element.

HARD TO DO
Non-obvious technical substance, constraints and implementation depth that make the idea defensible.

VALUE ADDING
Utility, adoption potential and a reason the invention should exist beyond novelty alone.

STUDENT-OWNED EVIDENCE
Invention canvas • prior-art search terms • novelty hypothesis • non-obviousness rationale • prototype or evidence plan.

Outcome 03 - Industry-ready innovators

UNIQUENESS
Spot opportunities others miss and frame a differentiated response rather than repeating obvious solutions.

HARD TO DO
Move from idea to execution: handle constraints, collaborate, experiment, learn and improve.

VALUE ADDING
Connect technical work to business, user and societal outcomes and explain why it matters.

STUDENT-OWNED EVIDENCE
Problem brief • prototype or concept • decision rationale • outcome story • pitch • 30/60-day action plan.

WHAT ACADEMIC LEADERS CAN REVIEW AFTER A COHORT
Problem portfolio • research directions • possible IP candidates • experiment plans • industry-facing pitches • participant capability evidence • recommended next steps.

The program builds capability and stronger pathways. Publication, patent and hiring outcomes are not guaranteed and depend on the quality of subsequent work, evidence, review and execution.

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